# Jacob Hukill

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## Research and Teaching Fields

Macroeconomics, Household Finance, Economics of Education

## Education

*University of Notre Dame* — Notre Dame, IN
Ph.D. in Economics — May 2027 (exp)
Dissertation: *The Macroeconomics of Financing Higher Education*
Committee: Jeffrey Campbell (Chair), Zachary Stangebye, Jeffrey Denning
M.A. in Economics — 2024

*Belmont University* — Nashville, TN
B.Sc. in Economics and Political Science (Summa Cum Laude) — 2019

## Job Market Paper

"Financing Human Capital Acquisition With Student Debt"

*Abstract:* I develop a life-cycle model of schooling, field-of-study choice, and student-debt repayment to study how higher-education finance affects the amount and composition of human capital. I simulate the ten-year transition following reforms to repayment terms, access to student credit, and tuition financing. By 2029, changing the repayment menu has little effect on educational attainment but substantially changes borrower liabilities. Eliminating new student credit reduces the bachelor's-degree stock among adults age 25 and older by 9 percent, the graduate-degree stock by 17 percent, and current enrollment by 59 percent relative to the status quo. Universal free tuition, financed by a proportional income tax, instead increases these outcomes by 3, 9, and 43 percent. Field-contingent policies reveal a tradeoff between concentrating graduates in targeted fields and producing targeted human capital. Restricting credit to STEM nearly triples the STEM share among current degree leavers, but reduces the bachelor's-degree stock and leaves aggregate student debt nearly unchanged. STEM-contingent free tuition more than doubles the STEM share while increasing bachelor's and graduate attainment. I calculate the value of human capital produced under each policy. At fixed labor input, STEM-contingent free tuition raises this value by 18 percent, compared with 2.8 percent under STEM-eligible credit. Thus, a policy can increase the targeted share of graduates partly by reducing completion outside the targeted field, while a less restrictive subsidy can produce more targeted human capital overall.

## Working Papers

"The Marginal Propensity to Consume Out of Student Debt Relief"

*Abstract:* I calculate the marginal propensity to consume student debt relief in a quantitative precautionary savings model. The fiscal expense of debt forgiveness is large and immediate, while the benefits free resources from recurring future debt payments, which reduces stimulus effects. By contrast, temporary forbearance that suspends current payments delivers immediate liquidity and produces MPCs close to those of cash transfers. Targeting a one-time transfer to indebted individuals rather than to all individuals raises the MPC by about 50 percent. The MPCs from debt relief are less than one third that of one time cash

transfers, and less than one fifth that of cash transfers to indebted individuals, while forbearance nearly matches the effectiveness of transfers to indebted households.

### Teaching Experience

- Teaching Assistant, Department of Economics, University of Notre Dame
  - Ph.D. Microeconomics I — Fall 2021 – Fall 2024
  - Ph.D. Microeconomics II — Spring 2022 – Spring 2025
  - Financial Econometrics — Fall 2025
  - Economics of Climate Change — Fall 2025
  - The Chinese Economy — Fall 2025
  - Game Theory — Spring 2026
- Instructor, Department of Economics, University of Notre Dame
  - Summer Math Camp — 2022 – 2023

### Honors and Awards

- Graduating Senior Award, Belmont University — 2019
- John W. Burgess Award, Belmont University — 2018
- University Hale Leadership Award, Belmont University — 2018

### Technical Skills

Matlab, Julia, C++, CUDA, Python

### Personal

Citizen of the United States.

### References


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Prof. Zachary Stangebye
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Prof. Jeffrey Denning
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